

AGENTS.md

Rules for any AI coding agent working in this repo. Read before writing code. Same file in every project – if something here doesn't fit, it's this file that's wrong, not the exception.

Before you touch anything

1. **Inspect before modifying.** Read the surrounding code and existing patterns before changing them. Prefer the project's existing approach over introducing a new one for the same problem.
2. **Ask, don't guess.** Ambiguous requirement, color, behaviour, or edge case → ask before implementing. Don't silently invent requirements.

While building

3. **No hardcoded values.** Colors, spacing, copy, URLs, feature flags come from config/theme – never inline in component code.
4. **One theme manager, one interaction layer.** All visual tokens come from a single centralized source (see DESIGN.md). Buttons, forms, and modals share one event-handling and state convention (loading / disabled / error) – no one-off styles per component.
5. **No shell implementations, no dead controls.** Connecting to any data or service layer – local

storage, a database, an API, auth – isn't "done" when it's initialized and a call is made; it's done when the write persists and the read returns it, verified by actually running the flow. A button that renders but does nothing doesn't ship silently – if it's UI-only on purpose, say so (see PROTOTYPE/).

6. **No AI slop.** No leftover placeholder text, no fake data standing in for real data, no unused scaffolding, no features nobody asked for.
7. **Preserve working functionality.** Minimise unnecessary changes – don't touch what wasn't asked for, and don't duplicate functionality that already exists.
8. **Stay in scope.** Build what SPEC.md says. Think something else is needed? Name it and ask.

Before calling it done

9. A feature isn't complete because the code exists – it's complete when the behaviour in TESTS.md is verified, and you ran it yourself rather than assuming it works.

Definition of done

- [] Every acceptance criterion in SPEC.md / TESTS.md is met
- [] Every button / interaction does what it visibly claims to do
- [] Every data-persistence path verified round-trip (survives a reload/restart), not just "call made"
- [] No hardcoded values introduced

- [] STATE.md is updated to reflect what actually happened

The process

SPEC.md → DESIGN.md → PROTOTYPE/ → **human approval** → ARCHITECTURE.md → implementation → TESTS.md → update STATE.md.

Nothing substantial gets built before the prototype is approved.